

High School - GIA

THE CIVIL RIGHTS

Crash Course

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U.S. History

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Starting the Crash Course being a history lover is a chapter focused on the movement during the 50s when the Civil Rights became a movement, it can be broken down into topics like The 1950s, The American Suburbs, The "Era of Consensus", segregation, desegregating schools, judicial decision, the aftermath of Brown vs. Board of Education, and The Emergence of the Civil Rights Movement, moments that were marked by the pain, like "no pain no gain" is how the moment is marked.

The 1950s in the United States were a time of significant transformation in many cultural, economic, and even social areas. After the devastation of World War II, the nation emerged as a global superpower, marked by economic prosperity and optimism. This era saw the birth of the "American Dream," characterized by the idealization of home ownership, stable employment, and consumer culture. Television became a centerpiece of family life, showcasing idealized suburban families that reinforced traditional gender roles. But beneath the facade of unity lay deep divisions, divisions that affected the world and affected people. Fear of communism during the Cold War led to McCarthyism, the famous political witch hunt. At the same time, racial segregation persisted, particularly in the South, as African Americans were denied equal access to education, housing, and public spaces. Although the decade is often remembered as an era of consensus and conformity, it also sowed the seeds for the social upheavals of the Civil Rights Movement and other challenges to the status.

The American Suburbs, the places that couldn't call home, are usually separate residential communities some distance away from a larger main city, like a dormitory, these areas are located beyond the perimeter of a city and are largely residential. But on the other hand, on the "money side", during this period, there was a wealthy and consumerist youth, who lived with the comforts that modernity offered them. Better housing conditions, the development of

communications, the search for the new, for comfort, and consumption are some of the characteristics of this era. Friends who served in the war returned, got loans through the GI Bill, and moved into new homes in places like Levittown. It stung to know that these neighborhoods, built with government support, were closed to people. Watching others flourish while excluded made the dream of a suburban life seem like a cruel joke.

The Era of Consensus, a quiet pressure to conform, the 50s felt like a period when everyone accepted how things should be, agreeing like a puppet. In the TV politicians said about the prosperity and union. The Era refers to a time when there seemed to be widespread agreement on core American values and ideals, particularly among the white middle class.

About the segregation, living under Jim Crow was a way of life, wasn't just a law. The pain of passing by drinking fountains labeled "Colored" and "White." Race was labeled as how it should live. Your color would define your life, and what you could or could not do. Your place might not be. Sitting at the back of the bus, no matter how tired you were. If someone "white" arrived, the seat was theirs. Segregation showed a lack of dignity and respect. People were treated in the worst way just because of the color of their skin. Schools were no different. Instead of building character, they were places where learning should be, where the honor of being in school every day seeking knowledge was rewarded with old books. The building was falling apart and the desks looked like they had been through a war.

In schools, the desegregation is a glimmer of hope. When the Supreme Court ruled in *Brown v. Board of Education*, it seemed like a light in the darkness of years. The question was being asked: Could this be the beginning of something new? The court ruled that segregation in schools was unconstitutional, the historic decision that reversed the *Plessy* decision, the heart-pounding reversal that historians love, and for the first time, it seemed like someone in

power was finally listening. Hearing the pleas, the pain, the sadness, and the cry for help, it became a clause called “Protection of Equals” found in the 14th Amendment of the United States Constitution. “The Civil Rights Act of 1964 was a landmark law that prohibited discrimination in the United States based on race, color, religion, sex, or national origin. It applied to employment, education, and access to public accommodations and facilities.” But the excitement didn’t last long. The Southern states found every excuse to postpone the decision, states that were marked by hardships, where there was no light at the end of the tunnel, and slaves worked hard to try to survive, but without a decent life. Parents protested governors promised to fight the decision, and schools remained closed instead of letting black and white children sit together. The desire was to believe that things would change, but watching the resistance made us realize how deeply rooted racism was. Still, the decision gave something that had not been seen for a long time: hope.

In conclusion, the 1950s were a decade of stark contradictions. They seemed to promise prosperity and progress, with expanding suburbs, new technologies, and the “American Dream” within reach, with the relentless pursuit of respect, honor, and dignity, always with the utmost integrity. But beneath the optimistic facade lay deep inequalities, particularly for black Americans, who faced systemic racism, appalling segregation, and exclusion from opportunities such as homeownership in the suburbs. Despite this, moments like the Brown v. Board of Education and small acts of defiance have managed to change long-entrenched injustice, offering hope for a more equitable future and planting the seeds for transformative change. Amid these challenges, acts of defiance like Rosa Parks' stand and the courage of leaders like Martin Luther King Jr. and the Little Rock Nine inspired a collective awakening. "no pain, no gain", even though it was created centuries later, shows that it is because

suffering is necessary to achieve something, many were those who suffered, but the fight for a greater life is what is called The Civil Rights.

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